

THE PHILOSOPHERS

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1. What profession/occupation would you like to have from those professions selected by the Philosophy students in the movie “The Philosophers”. Why?

- Personally, I would say none as I am proud to be a Web Developer (a branch of IT). However, in such situation, I would prefer to be a farmer since I would have the right knowledge which plants grow in my area and what plants can be planted. Just as James, the farmer, did in the first thought scenario; I would gather all possible edible plants in my area so that I will have a stock of seeds to grow in the bunker and if developed, I would not only the produce it will provide, but also seeds that can be planted after the apocalypse.

2. If given the opportunity to choose one member/profession to be with you inside the bunker, who/what would it be? Why?

- A great question as I will be divided into two: one that will choose the most useful occupation and one that will choose to save humanity. However, one person stands out the most and merge this division who is Petra. Not only that she is a structural and an electrical engineer, but also a woman; just as Chip stated. She is capable of planning and designing what materials to be used in order to construct a building, or in case of aftermath, a simple wooden house; and dealing with the electrical problems inside the bunker and a possible reestablishment of electricity in the aftermath. Moreover, she will also be able to save humanity as we can try to procreate ensuring that there will be a new generation of human species.

3. What was the real reason why many died in the movie?

- Short answer (satire): It is because of a nuclear war in their thought experiment.
- True long answer: I believe that there are 3 reasons and an extra one as to why many died in the movie: **situation**, **decision**, **trust**, and the extra one; **perception**. These four reasons can be linked to the 4 mentioned philosophical thoughts in the movie: “**Infinite Monkey**”, “**Trolley Problem**”, “**Ignorant Bliss**”, and “**Plato’s Cave**”. Firstly, many died in the movie as there were many possibilities, situations, and events that could’ve had occurred and one of those were the first 2 thought scenarios. Similar to the Infinite Monkey, only a smallest and fractional amount of situations will lead them to survival since in an apocalypse, only then will the unknown be discovered; a path of many deduced to a fatality. Secondly, does letting 1 person with a professional job worth saving more than 5 people with artistic jobs? The answer is no. In an apocalypse, all is equal. Mr. Zimmit killing the 11 people with artistic jobs does not justify choosing to save the other 10 professional ones. And even if logic and rationality will help to give the highest possible chance, it’s too small and fractional that it’s value is worthless. This ties to the situation/Infinite Monkey.

Third, having seen Mr. Zimmit kill those people with unworthy jobs, why would the other trust someone that can do the same to them? Also, setting your thought experiment in your own favor, in this sense his own logic, will not go as planned as the human mind is complex enough to deviate from its own logic, especially when an alarming and apocalyptic scenario is at play. Lastly, the perception of each character is different from one another. Just as the Plato's cave allegory, human's perceive things as they see it but not as what it really is. Humans create their world through what they experienced and feel rather than understanding what their world is. Using this as a basis, Mr. Zimmit tried to impose his own idea of only those who abide to logic and rationality will survive.

**4. What was the main reason why the philosophy professor has to end his life?
(one of the three possible endings for Zimit – in the second one, he pulls a gun out his drawer and we hear a gunshot, the assumption being that he ended his life rather than go on without Petra)**

- His three possible endings are all his thought experiments for himself without a life of being with Petra. Now, his second scenario terminating himself is a path he can take as he realized that he had always been the person in the allegory of Plato's cave. He remarked that he was chained to his own logic and rationality without trying to look around and perceiving and accepting another logic or truth. He was imposing that only the intellectual people will survive in an apocalyptic event. Moreover, he was indirectly telling Petra that he was the right person for her and she should choose to be with him. Therefore, he failed as a Philosopher professor since the meaning of Philosophy is to love knowledge yet he only loved his own.